



Google Assistant vs Siri

One of the big announcements from Google I/O 2017 was that Assistant is coming to iOS, taking a shot at Apple's Siri. <http://digit.in/SiriGA>



OLED display for LG V30

LG is reportedly moving to OLED panels for its flagship smartphones with the launch of the V30 in Q3 this year. <http://digit.in/LGv30OLED>

Who let the cats out – on the Internet?

If you've ever wondered exactly how the Internet came to be so obsessed with the kitteh, read on.

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uch like the way energy flows through different species up a food chain, one can trace dependencies in

how species are obliged to put up with personal discomfort for the sake of others. For instance, the devilish lamprey can piggyback on porpoises and whales for days on end, an unwelcome, unshakable parasite – pretty much an in-law. Human beings, on the other hand, have taken a zero-tolerance policy towards inconvenience. We dispatch with firm and often mean hands, the pestering presence of insects, reptiles, and even powerful carnivores.

Against this backdrop, it is particularly strange to see that many a human will drop the above mentioned zero tolerance policy to happily wait for a cat to rub against his leg four-and-a-half times, lead her up to the open door, observe her arched-back dramatisation of being undecided, coax her to leave, and on occasion, get clawed for being friendly – before the blasted creature decides not to go out after all, thank you very much.

What is up with these animals? What is it that grasps the human fascination so much that we will tolerate the worst possible behaviour from cats and cats alone, and yet reward it with love and cooing? Perhaps a better way to look at it is to question what is up with cat people? Dog people we can understand – may they live long and happy lives with their veritable wide eyed, cuddly soul-mates. Cat people

though are a strange lot. They have propelled to the top of the charts an animal that perhaps has the least interest in popularity.

This perverse trend has spanned the millennia – from the Egyptians sending humans to toil on the pyramids but bowing down with a saucerful of milk for every passing feline, to the unquestionable global hold



To the internets me mateys

of feline memes in the past decades. Today, we think the unthinkable, ask the unaskable, and resolve to rightly get to the bottom of this mystery – why are cat memes consistently the biggest meme behemoths on the internet?

THE PROOF

We begin with the evidence that cat

memes have indeed held the internet in the tightest vice, for the longest time.

A review of Google ngrams shows the interest in 'cat memes' being consistently higher than that in any other kind of animal memes. As if that's not enough, any purveyor of the internet's biggest user generated content hubs – be it Imgur, Reddit, Youtube, Facebook, or even Whatsapp forwards – will have recognized the unquestionable dominance of cats in the general internet consciousness.

For slightly more deductive reasoning, consider this: Stanford computer scientist and popular machine learning expert Andrew Ng, in collaboration with his colleagues, created an 'artificial neural network' that used thumbnails from YouTube videos to identify the topic of the video. The paper, titled 'Building High-level Features Using Large Scale Unsupervised Learning' had a seminal result. The neural network developed an extraordinarily good ability to identify cats, as compared to humans being, dogs, and a list of about 20,000 other entities. The reason for this is obvious – there are simply that many cat videos on the internet.

The writing's on the wall – cats rule, at least on the internet. Much to the dismay of the furball currently demanding attention on the writer's left, the mission is now to find out why.